

FLEXIBLE AND INCLUSIVE

The steel major believes that flexibility empowers people and empowered employees give the best results

By **Ashish Rukhaiyar**

► **TATA STEEL IS** a steel company, right? To Atrayee Sanyal, the company's Vice President of Human Resource Management, Tata Steel isn't just a steel company. It is also a large mining firm, the largest engineering & projects entity and the one with the biggest IT & digital teams in the sector, she says.

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Not to forget the many other businesses related to materials and services, she adds. Perhaps, that's why the company—founded 115 years ago—scored high on 'Growth and Learning Opportunities' in the latest *BT-Taggd Best Companies to Work For in India* study. "There are so many opportunities [for employees] and therefore probably you have... [such high scores]," says Sanyal, a Tata Steel veteran of nearly 15 years. "If they [the employees] want to be in the steel business, whether it is manufacturing, procurement, digital supply chain, e-commerce, new materials, durables or even R&D, the opportunities are huge within the company," she says.

However, managing 35,000 employees with a median age of around 40 years is no easy task, given the last couple of years when the pandemic forced companies and their HR chiefs to put in place a completely new strategy in terms of work culture and environment.

Interestingly, around a year ago, Tata Steel launched an internal AI-based platform that allowed employees to upload their profile—something on the lines of LinkedIn—and also apply for various projects within the company. It is like an internal gig-working platform where people can experience any kind of career within the company, says Sanyal, adding that over time the platform will become more intelligent and even suggest mentors and showcase the progress of employees.

Another parameter on which the company scored high was 'Flexibility at work', which many companies have been forced to adopt in the last couple of years. But Tata Steel, Sanyal says, embarked on the journey much be-



EMPOWERING EMPLOYEES Atrayee Sanyal, Vice President, Human Resource Management, Tata Steel

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TATA STEEL

Top attributes

- Clarity of company goals
- Growth and learning opportunities
- Flexibility at work